

Question 1: Tell me about yourself.

Good morning, sir/madam.

My name is Rohan Rajabhau Indalkar, and I am currently pursuing a Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Engineering at ISB&M College of Engineering, Pune. Before that, I completed my Diploma in Computer Engineering with 86.84%.

I am passionate about Java Full Stack Development and have learned technologies such as Java, Spring Boot, Spring Security, React.js, MySQL, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and REST APIs. I have also completed my Java Full Stack Development training at InfoBeans Foundation, where I gained hands-on experience in building full-stack web applications, developing REST APIs, and implementing secure authentication using JWT.

I enjoy solving real-world problems through software development. One of my projects is SkillTrack Pro, an AI-powered Institute Training and Student Success Platform developed for InfoBeans Foundation. It is a full-stack web application designed to digitize institute management. The platform includes student, trainer, and admin management, attendance tracking, assignment management, performance analytics, secure role-based authentication, AI-powered insights, notifications, and report generation. Working on this project gave me practical experience in developing scalable, real-world enterprise applications and strengthened my skills in both backend and frontend development.

Also build Rent Anything, a rental management backend API built using Spring Boot, MySQL, and JWT Authentication.

I enjoy learning new technologies and continuously improving my technical and communication skills.

2: Walk me through your resume.

My name is Rohan Rajabhau Indalkar, and I am currently pursuing a Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Engineering at ISB&M College of Engineering, Pune. Before that, I completed my Diploma in Computer Engineering with 86.84%.

Regarding my technical skills, I have worked with Java, Spring Boot, Spring Security, React.js, MySQL, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and REST APIs. I also have hands-on experience with Git, GitHub, Postman, Docker, and MongoDB.

I completed my Java Full Stack Development training at InfoBeans Foundation, where I gained practical experience in developing backend applications, building REST APIs, implementing JWT-based authentication, and working on full-stack web development.

My major project is SkillTrack Pro, an AI-powered Institute Training and Student Success Platform developed for InfoBeans Foundation. It is a full-stack application that includes student, trainer, and admin management, attendance tracking, assignment management, performance analytics, secure role-based authentication, AI-powered insights, notifications, and report generation. Through this project, I strengthened my skills in designing scalable applications, integrating frontend and backend, and working with databases.

Overall, I am passionate about software development, enjoy learning new technologies, and continuously improve my technical and communication skills. I am now looking for an opportunity where I can contribute to real-world projects while growing as a Java Full Stack Developer.

That's a brief overview of my resume. Thank you."

Tell me something about yourself that is not in your resume.

One thing that isn't mentioned in my resume is my strong commitment to continuous learning and self-improvement.

I believe that technical skills alone are not enough to become a successful software engineer. That's why I spend time every day improving my communication skills, practicing coding problems, and learning new technologies beyond my college curriculum.

I also enjoy taking on challenging projects that solve real-world problems. For example, while developing SkillTrack Pro, I pushed myself to learn new concepts and build a complete full-stack application instead of limiting myself to basic academic projects. This experience improved not only my technical knowledge but also my problem-solving and planning skills.

Apart from technology, I believe in being disciplined, adaptable, and maintaining a positive attitude. I enjoy working with others, learning from feedback, and continuously improving myself. These qualities help me grow both personally and professionally.

Thank you."

How do you keep yourself updated with new technologies?

"I believe technology is constantly evolving, so continuous learning is very important for a software developer.

To keep myself updated, I regularly follow the official documentation of technologies like Java, Spring Boot, and React to learn about new features and best practices.

I also watch tutorials and technical content on YouTube, follow developers on LinkedIn, and read articles on platforms like Medium and GeeksforGeeks.

Most importantly, I believe in learning by doing. Whenever I learn a new concept, I try to implement it in a project. For example, while building SkillTrack Pro, I explored technologies such as JWT Authentication, role-based access control, REST APIs, and React integration. Building real projects helps me understand technologies much better than just reading about them.

I also practice coding regularly to improve my problem-solving skills and stay consistent with my learning."

Why do you enjoy software development?

"I enjoy software development because it allows me to solve real-world problems through technology. Every project gives me an opportunity to learn something new and improve my skills.

One thing I like most is turning an idea into a working application. From designing the user interface to developing the backend and connecting the database, I enjoy every stage of the development process.

For example, while building SkillTrack Pro, I worked on features like student management, attendance tracking, role-based authentication, and performance analytics. Seeing these features work together and solve real problems for an institute gave me a great sense of satisfaction.

I also enjoy software development because technology is always evolving. There is always something new to learn, which keeps me motivated and helps me grow as a developer.

Overall, software development combines creativity, logical thinking, and continuous learning, which is why I chose it as my career."

Thank you.

Why did you choose Java Full Stack Development?

"I chose Java Full Stack Development because it allows me to build complete web applications, from the frontend to the backend and the database. I enjoy understanding how an entire application works rather than focusing on just one part of it.

I selected Java because it is one of the most reliable and widely used programming languages in the software industry. Many enterprise applications are built using Java, and it offers excellent frameworks like Spring Boot for developing secure and scalable applications.

I also enjoy working with frontend technologies like React.js, HTML, CSS, and JavaScript because they help create responsive and user-friendly interfaces.

While developing projects such as Rent Anything and SkillTrack Pro, I realized that I enjoy designing REST APIs, integrating the frontend with the backend, managing databases, and implementing secure authentication. These experiences strengthened my interest in becoming a Java Full Stack Developer.

My goal is to build scalable, high-quality applications and continuously improve my skills by working on real-world projects."

Thank you.

What is your biggest strength?

"I believe my biggest strength is my willingness to learn and my consistency.

Whenever I come across a new technology or a challenging problem, I don't give up easily. Instead, I take it as an opportunity to learn and improve myself.

For example, while developing SkillTrack Pro, I had to work with multiple technologies like Spring Boot, React.js, JWT Authentication, REST APIs, and MySQL. Whenever I faced a challenge, I spent time understanding the problem, referred to documentation, and practiced until I found the right solution. This approach helped me improve both my technical knowledge and problem-solving skills.

Another strength is that I adapt quickly to new environments and technologies. I enjoy working in a team, accept feedback positively, and continuously work on improving myself.

I believe these qualities will help me contribute effectively to the organization while continuing to grow as a software engineer.

Thank you."

What is your biggest weakness?

"As a fresher, one area I'm continuously working on is gaining more real-world industry experience. Most of my knowledge comes from training and personal projects, so I know there is still a lot to learn.

To overcome this, I build practical projects like SkillTrack Pro, practice coding regularly, and keep learning new technologies. I see this as a temporary weakness that will improve as I work on real projects and learn from experienced professionals."

Why should we hire you?

As a fresher, I may not have industry experience, but I have a strong foundation in Java Full Stack Development and a great willingness to learn.

I have hands-on experience with technologies such as Java, Spring Boot, Spring Security, React.js, MySQL, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and REST APIs. During my training at InfoBeans Foundation, I worked on real-world projects that helped me understand how to build scalable and secure web applications.

One of my major projects is SkillTrack Pro, an AI-powered Institute Training and Student Success Platform, where I worked on features such as role-based authentication, student and trainer management, attendance tracking, and performance analytics. This project strengthened my technical, problem-solving, and teamwork skills.

Apart from technical skills, I am a quick learner, adaptable, hardworking, and open to feedback. I enjoy learning new technologies and continuously improving myself.

I believe that if I am given this opportunity, I will learn quickly, contribute positively to the team, and work with dedication to help achieve the company's goals.

What motivates you?

"What motivates me the most is learning new things and solving real-world problems through technology.

Whenever I learn a new concept or successfully complete a challenging feature, it gives me confidence and motivates me to improve further.

For example, while developing SkillTrack Pro, every time I completed a feature such as role-based authentication, attendance management, or performance analytics, it motivated me to take on more challenging tasks. Seeing my work solve a real problem was very satisfying.

I am also motivated by opportunities to work with experienced professionals, receive feedback, and continuously improve my technical and professional skills.

My biggest motivation is becoming a skilled software engineer who can contribute to meaningful projects and create value for the organization."

Thank you.

What if we assign you a technology you don't know?

"I would see it as an opportunity to learn something new rather than as a challenge.

As a fresher, I understand that I won't know every technology, but I am confident in my ability to learn quickly. I would start by understanding the basics through the official documentation, online resources, and guidance from experienced team members. Then I would practice by building small examples before applying the technology to the actual project.

In my learning journey, I have followed this same approach whenever I encountered new technologies, and it has helped me build projects successfully.

I believe that having the right attitude, curiosity, and willingness to learn is more important than already knowing every technology. If the company provides me with an opportunity, I will put in the effort to learn quickly and contribute effectively."

Where do you see yourself in 5 years?

"In the next five years, I see myself as a skilled and reliable Java Full Stack Developer who has gained strong technical expertise and practical industry experience.

As a fresher, my first priority is to learn from experienced professionals, work on challenging projects, and continuously improve my technical and problem-solving skills.

Over time, I would like to take on more responsibilities, contribute to important projects, mentor junior team members, and become someone the team can rely on.

I also want to keep learning new technologies and stay updated with industry trends so that I can contribute to building scalable and high-quality software solutions.

I hope to grow along with the organization and build a long-term career where both the company and I achieve success together."

Tell me about your family.

I come from a supportive family based in Maharashtra. My family has always encouraged me to focus on my education, work hard, and become an independent and responsible person.

Their support has motivated me to pursue a career in Java Full Stack Development and continuously improve my technical and communication skills.

We believe in values such as honesty, discipline, respect, and hard work, and these values have shaped my personality. My family has always encouraged me to face challenges with confidence and keep learning from every experience.

Their constant support inspires me to achieve my career goals and contribute positively to my organization.

What are your career goals?

"My career goal is to become a highly skilled Java Full Stack Developer and continuously grow as a software engineer.

In the short term, I want to join a company where I can work on real-world projects, learn from experienced professionals, and strengthen my technical skills in technologies such as Java, Spring Boot, React.js, and cloud technologies.

Over the long term, I aim to take on greater responsibilities, contribute to the design and development of scalable enterprise applications, and become a dependable team member who can also mentor junior developers.

I believe that continuous learning, hard work, and adaptability are essential for long-term success. My goal is to grow along with the organization while making meaningful contributions to its success."

Why do you want to work for our company?

I want to work for your company because of its strong reputation for innovation, quality, and employee growth. From what I have learned, your organization provides opportunities to work on real-world projects, learn from experienced professionals, and use modern technologies.

As a fresher, I am looking for an environment where I can apply my Java Full Stack skills, continuously learn, and contribute to meaningful projects. I believe your company offers the right platform for both professional and personal growth.

I am also impressed by your work culture, focus on teamwork, and commitment to delivering high-quality solutions to clients. These are the kind of values I want to be part of.

I am confident that working here will help me grow as a software engineer, and at the same time, I will contribute with my dedication, willingness to learn, and technical skills.

Thank you.

Why our company and not another company?"

Answer:

"Every company has its strengths, but what attracted me to your company is its learning environment, strong technical culture, and the opportunity to work on real-world projects. As a fresher, my priority is to build a strong foundation, and I believe your organization is the right place to achieve that."

Interview Tip

Before every interview, spend 10–15 minutes researching:

- What the company does
- Its products or services
- Recent achievements or news
- Company values
- The job description

What are your salary expectations?

"As a fresher, my primary goal is to start my career, gain practical experience, and continuously improve my skills. At this stage, learning and growth are more important to me than salary.

I believe your company has a standard compensation structure for freshers, and I am comfortable with the package offered for this role. I am confident that if I perform well and contribute to the organization, my growth and compensation will naturally follow.

Interviewer: *"Can you give us a salary range?"*

"Based on my research, the market salary for freshers in this role is around ₹4–6 LPA. However, I am flexible and comfortable with the company's compensation policy."

1. If another company offers you a higher salary, what will you do?

"Salary is definitely an important factor, but it is not the only factor I consider while making a career decision. As a fresher, my priority is to work in an organization where I can learn, grow, and build a strong technical foundation.

If another company offers a higher salary, I would first evaluate the learning opportunities, the type of projects, the work culture, and my long-term career growth. If I believe that my current company provides better opportunities to develop my skills and build my career, I would prefer to continue here.

I believe that if I perform well and contribute to the organization, my compensation will naturally grow over time."

Thank you.

What is more important to you—salary or learning?

"Both are important, but at this stage of my career, learning is my top priority.

As a fresher, I believe that gaining practical experience, working with experienced professionals, and improving my technical skills will help me build a strong career. Once I develop my skills and contribute to the organization, I believe good compensation will naturally follow.

That's why my current focus is on learning, taking on new challenges, and becoming a skilled Java Full Stack Developer."

Thank you.

What are your hobbies and interests?

"My primary interest is learning new technologies and improving my software development skills.

In my free time, I enjoy exploring new concepts in Java Full Stack Development, reading technical articles, watching technology-related videos, and building personal projects to apply what I learn.

For example, while developing SkillTrack Pro, I explored concepts such as role-based authentication, REST API integration, and React-based frontend development. Working on projects like these helps me strengthen both my technical knowledge and problem-solving skills.

I also spend time improving my communication skills and preparing for interviews because I believe both technical expertise and effective communication are important for becoming a successful software engineer.

Overall, I enjoy activities that help me learn, grow, and become a better developer."

Thank you.

Tell me about your biggest achievement.

"I would say my biggest achievement so far is developing *SkillTrack Pro*, an AI-powered Institute Training and Student Success Platform for InfoBeans Foundation.

This project was much more than a college project. I designed and developed it as a complete full-stack application using React.js, Spring Boot, MySQL, REST APIs, and JWT Authentication.

The platform includes features such as student, trainer, and admin management, attendance tracking, assignment management, performance analytics, role-based authentication, notifications, and AI-powered insights.

The biggest challenge was integrating the frontend, backend, authentication, and database into a single application while ensuring that different user roles had secure access to their respective features. Successfully completing this project improved my technical skills, problem-solving ability, and understanding of enterprise application development.

More importantly, it gave me the confidence that I can build real-world software solutions and continue growing as a Java Full Stack Developer.

Thank you."

"Tell me about a failure and what you learned from it."

"When I first started learning Spring Boot, I found it difficult to understand concepts like dependency injection, Spring Security, and JWT Authentication.

Initially, I struggled to implement these concepts in my projects, and I made several mistakes.

Instead of giving up, I studied the official documentation, practiced with small examples, and gradually implemented these concepts in my projects.

That experience taught me that consistency and patience are the keys to learning any new technology."

Earlier, I was not very confident while speaking in English or answering interview questions.

I realized that communication is an important skill for every software engineer.

To improve, I started practicing English every day, participating in discussions, and preparing HR interview questions regularly.

Although I am still learning, I have become much more confident than before, and I continue to improve every day."

What do you know about our company?

"Before coming to this interview, I spent some time learning about your company.

I understand that your company is a well-established organization known for delivering high-quality technology solutions and serving clients across various industries. I also learned that the company values innovation, teamwork, continuous learning, and customer satisfaction.

I was particularly impressed by your focus on employee development and the opportunity to work on real-world projects using modern technologies. As a fresher, I believe this is the kind of environment where I can learn from experienced professionals, improve my technical skills, and contribute to meaningful projects.

That's one of the main reasons I was excited to apply for this opportunity."

★ Short Version (30 seconds)

"I know that your company is a reputed organization with a strong focus on innovation, customer satisfaction, and employee growth. I was impressed by your work culture and learning opportunities, which is why I am excited about the possibility of starting my career here."

Do you have any questions for us?

"Yes, thank you. I have a few questions."

Question 1

"Could you please tell me about the training process for freshers in your company?"

Question 2

"What technologies and projects will I be working on if I am selected?"

Question 3

"How do you measure the performance of a fresher during the initial months?"

"Thank you. Those are my questions."

Why do you want to join a startup?

"I want to join a startup because it provides an excellent learning environment where I can take on diverse responsibilities and grow quickly.

As a fresher, my priority is to gain practical experience by working on real-world projects. In a startup, I believe I will have the opportunity to contribute to different aspects of product development, learn directly from experienced team members, and understand how software is built from idea to deployment.

I also enjoy solving challenging problems and continuously learning new technologies. I believe the fast-paced and collaborative environment of a startup will help me improve both my technical and professional skills.

My goal is to contribute with dedication, learn as much as possible, and grow along with the company."

Why should we not hire you?

"I don't think there is a strong reason not to hire me. Although I am a fresher and don't have industry experience yet, I have built a solid foundation in Java Full Stack Development through my training and projects.

I understand that there will be a learning curve when I join the company, but I am a quick learner, adaptable, and always willing to take feedback and improve myself.

I have worked on projects like SkillTrack Pro and Rent Anything, which have given me practical experience in building full-stack applications using technologies such as Java, Spring Boot, React.js, MySQL, and JWT Authentication.

If your organization is looking for someone who is eager to learn, works hard, and is committed to continuous improvement, I believe I would be a good fit for this role.

Are you willing to relocate?

"Yes, I am willing to relocate if the role requires it.

I understand that working in different locations is a part of many organizations, especially in the IT industry. I see relocation as an opportunity to learn, gain new experiences, and work with different teams.

As long as the role provides good learning opportunities and supports my professional growth, I am comfortable relocating."

Are you willing to work night shifts?

"Yes, I am willing to work night shifts if the role and business requirements demand it.

I understand that many IT companies work with global clients across different time zones, and flexibility is an important part of the job.

As a fresher, my priority is to learn, contribute to the team, and adapt to the organization's requirements. I am comfortable working night shifts whenever required, while maintaining a healthy work-life balance and ensuring that my performance remains consistent.

What makes you different from other candidates?

"Every candidate has their own strengths, so I prefer to focus on what I can bring to the role.

I believe what makes me different is my combination of a strong learning mindset, hands-on project experience, and dedication to continuous improvement.

Although I am a fresher, I have gained practical experience by building projects like SkillTrack Pro and Rent Anything, where I worked with technologies such as Java, Spring Boot, React.js, MySQL, REST APIs, and JWT Authentication.

I enjoy learning new technologies, accept feedback positively, and don't hesitate to take on challenges. When I face a problem, I try to understand the root cause and find the right solution instead of looking for shortcuts.

I believe these qualities will help me adapt quickly, contribute effectively to the team, and grow into a reliable software engineer.

How can you contribute without experience?

"Although I don't have industry experience, I have practical experience from full-stack projects and training. I can contribute by applying my technical skills, learning quickly, collaborating with the team, and taking ownership of my responsibilities."

Why did you choose Computer Engineering?

"I chose Computer Engineering because I have always been interested in technology and problem-solving."

When I started learning programming, I realized that I enjoyed writing code and building applications that solve real-world problems. That interest motivated me to pursue Computer Engineering.

During my studies, I learned subjects like programming, data structures, databases, operating systems, and software engineering, which gave me a strong technical foundation.

Later, through my Java Full Stack training and projects like SkillTrack Pro and Rent Anything, my interest in software development became even stronger. I enjoyed building complete applications and understanding how the frontend, backend, and database work together.

That's why I decided to build my career as a Java Full Stack Developer

Why did you choose Java instead of Python, JavaScript, or C#?

"I chose Java because it is one of the most widely used programming languages for building enterprise applications."

Java provides strong object-oriented programming concepts, platform independence, excellent performance, and a large ecosystem. Frameworks like Spring Boot make it easier to develop secure, scalable, and maintainable applications.

As I started learning Java and working on projects, I became interested in backend development. Through projects like SkillTrack Pro and Rent Anything, I used Java along with Spring Boot to build REST APIs, implement JWT-based authentication, and develop backend services.

I understand that languages like Python, JavaScript, and C# also have their own strengths, and I am open to learning them whenever required. However, I chose Java because it aligns with my interest in enterprise software development and offers strong long-term career opportunities.

Why should we hire you over another candidate with similar skills?

"I believe every candidate brings their own strengths and experiences, so I prefer not to compare myself with others."

What I can confidently say is that I bring a strong learning mindset, practical project experience, and a sincere commitment to continuous improvement.

Through projects like SkillTrack Pro and Rent Anything, I have gained hands-on experience in Java, Spring Boot, React.js, MySQL, REST APIs, and JWT Authentication. These projects have helped me understand how to build secure and scalable applications while improving my problem-solving skills.

I am also a quick learner, adaptable, and open to feedback. Whenever I face a new challenge, I take the initiative to learn and find the right solution. If given the opportunity, I will work with dedication, take ownership of my responsibilities, and continuously strive to add value to the team.

Ultimately, I would like my work, attitude, and willingness to learn to speak for me."

"I believe my teammates and mentors would describe me as a responsible, cooperative, and quick learner."

During my academic projects and Java Full Stack training, I always tried to contribute actively, complete my tasks on time, and support my teammates whenever needed.

They would also say that I remain calm while solving problems and that I am open to feedback. I believe constructive feedback helps me improve, so I always try to learn from my mentors and apply their suggestions.

Overall, I think they would describe me as someone who is reliable, positive, and willing to learn and grow."

Tell me about a time when you worked in a team.

- **S – Situation**
- **T – Task**
- **A – Action**
- **R – Result**

Situation

"During my Java Full Stack training, our team was assigned to develop a web application as part of our project work."

Task

"My responsibility was to develop the backend APIs using Java and Spring Boot and coordinate with my teammates to ensure the frontend and backend were integrated properly."

Action

"I divided my work into smaller tasks, completed the assigned APIs on time, and regularly communicated with my teammates. Whenever we faced integration issues or bugs, we discussed them together, identified the root cause, and resolved them collaboratively."

Result

"As a result, we successfully completed the project within the deadline. The experience taught me the importance of teamwork, communication, and supporting each other to achieve a common goal."

Thank you.

What did you learn from working in a team?

"I learned that clear communication, mutual respect, and supporting teammates are just as important as technical skills. A successful project depends on collaboration."

Describe a situation where you had to learn something new quickly.

Situation

"During my Java Full Stack training, I started working on **SkillTrack Pro**. While developing the project, I realized I needed to implement JWT-based authentication and role-based authorization, which I had not worked with before."

Task

"My goal was to understand JWT authentication thoroughly and integrate it securely into the application so that Admin, Trainer, and Student could access only their authorized resources."

Action

"I created a learning plan by studying the Spring Security documentation, watching technical tutorials, and practicing with small examples before implementing it in the project. I tested the APIs using Postman, debugged issues, and refined the implementation until the authentication flow worked correctly."

Result

"I successfully integrated JWT authentication into the project and gained a solid understanding of Spring Security. This experience increased my confidence in learning new technologies quickly and applying them in real-world projects."

Thank you.

How do you handle pressure and tight deadlines?

"I believe pressure is a normal part of any professional job, especially in the IT industry. Instead of getting stressed, I focus on planning and prioritizing my work."

When I have a tight deadline, I first understand the requirements, divide the work into smaller tasks, and prioritize the most important ones. I also keep track of my progress and communicate with my team if I face any blockers.

During my academic projects, there were times when we had limited time to complete development and testing. By planning properly, collaborating with my teammates, and staying focused, we completed the project on time.

I believe staying calm, managing time effectively, and asking for help when needed are the keys to handling pressure successfully."

Have you ever missed a deadline?

"Fortunately, in my academic projects I have managed to meet deadlines by planning my work early. If I ever realize there is a risk of delay, I communicate it immediately and work with the team to find a solution."

What if your manager gives you an impossible deadline?

"I would first understand the expectations and estimate the effort required. If the timeline is genuinely unrealistic, I would discuss it professionally with my manager, explain the challenges, and suggest a practical plan or phased delivery while staying committed to delivering quality work."

If you make a mistake at work, what will you do?

"I believe mistakes are a part of learning, especially at the beginning of a career. The important thing is how we respond to them.

If I make a mistake, I will first take responsibility instead of trying to hide it or blame someone else. Then I will analyze the root cause, correct the mistake as quickly as possible, and inform my manager or team if it affects the project.

After resolving the issue, I will identify what I learned from the experience and take steps to prevent the same mistake from happening again. I believe being honest, learning from feedback, and continuously improving are essential qualities for a software engineer."

Would you hide your mistake if nobody noticed?

"No. Hiding a mistake can create bigger problems later. I believe honesty and transparency build trust, so I would report it and work on resolving it immediately.

What if your mistake affects the entire team?

"I would immediately inform the team, explain the issue honestly, help fix it as quickly as possible, and work together to minimize the impact. Afterward, I would review what went wrong and improve the process to reduce the chance of it happening again."

What are your expectations from your first job?

"As a fresher, my primary expectation from my first job is to learn, grow, and gain practical industry experience.

I want to work on real-world projects where I can apply my knowledge of **Java, Spring Boot, React.js, and databases** while learning from experienced professionals.

I also hope to receive constructive feedback, mentorship, and opportunities to improve both my technical and communication skills. Working in a collaborative environment where I can contribute to meaningful projects is very important to me.

While salary is important, my main focus at this stage of my career is building strong technical skills, gaining industry exposure, and becoming a dependable software engineer."

What if the work is repetitive?

"I understand that every role has routine tasks. I will complete them sincerely because they help build discipline and understanding. At the same time, I will continue learning new skills so I can take on more responsibilities over time."

2. What kind of work environment do you prefer?

"I prefer a collaborative and professional environment where team members support each other, share knowledge, and encourage continuous learning."

3. What are your expectations from your manager?

"I expect clear guidance, constructive feedback, and opportunities to learn. I appreciate managers who encourage questions, support professional growth, and help team members improve."

If you receive multiple job offers, how will you decide which company to join?

"If I receive multiple job offers, I would carefully evaluate each opportunity based on several factors rather than focusing only on salary."

First, I would consider the learning opportunities and the technologies I would be working with. As a fresher, building strong technical skills is my highest priority.

Second, I would look at the company's work culture, mentorship, training programs, and opportunities for career growth. Working with experienced professionals in a positive environment would help me grow faster.

Finally, I would consider the role, responsibilities, and how well they align with my long-term goal of becoming a skilled Java Full Stack Developer.

After evaluating all these factors, I would choose the company where I believe I can learn the most, contribute effectively, and build a long-term career."

Thank you.

What if another company offers a higher salary?

"If the difference is reasonable, I would still prioritize learning, growth, and career opportunities. I believe strong skills and experience will naturally lead to better financial rewards in the future."

2. Would you leave us if another company offers more money?

"My goal is to build a stable, long-term career. I would not switch jobs only for a higher salary. I value learning, meaningful work, and professional growth, and I would make such decisions carefully."

3. Which is more important: Salary or Learning?

"At this stage of my career, learning is more important. A strong foundation, practical experience, and continuous growth will help me achieve better career opportunities and financial rewards in the long run."

1. Tell me about your project.

"My project is **IBNextStep – AI Powered Placement Readiness & Recruitment Management System**.

The main objective of this project is to digitize and automate the entire placement preparation process for training institutes. Many institutes still manage students using Excel sheets, Google Forms, WhatsApp groups, and manual reports, which makes it difficult to track student progress and manage placement activities efficiently.

The system has four user roles:

- **Admin** manages students, trainers, HR users, batches, company drives, reports, and analytics.
- **Trainer** manages attendance, study materials, assignments, coding assessments, and mock interviews while tracking student performance.
- **Student** accesses study materials, submits assignments, practices coding, tracks progress, and applies for company drives.
- **HR** manages company drives, shortlists eligible candidates, schedules interviews, and updates placement results.

From a technical perspective, I developed the backend using **Java 21, Spring Boot, Spring Security, JWT Authentication, MongoDB, Redis, WebSocket, Spring Scheduler, Cloudinary, and Judge0 API**. The frontend is built using **React, Vite, Tailwind CSS, and Shadcn UI**.

My primary responsibility was designing the backend architecture, implementing secure REST APIs, JWT authentication, role-based authorization, MongoDB database design, file upload, email notifications, WebSocket notifications, and integrating external services like Judge0 and Cloudinary. I also designed the business workflows and API documentation using Swagger."

2. Why did you build this project?

"I built this project to solve a real problem faced by many training institutes during placement preparation.

Most institutes still use multiple disconnected tools such as Excel sheets, Google Forms, WhatsApp groups, emails, and manual reports. As the number of students grows, these tools become difficult to manage.

For example:

- Student information is stored in Excel.
- Attendance is maintained separately.
- Assignments are shared through WhatsApp or Google Drive.
- Coding test results are stored on different platforms.
- Mock interview feedback is maintained manually.
- HR receives candidate details through emails or spreadsheets.

Because the data is scattered across different systems, trainers cannot easily monitor student progress, admins spend a lot of time performing repetitive manual tasks, and HR teams find it difficult to identify placement-ready candidates.

To solve these problems, I built a centralized web application where Admins, Trainers, Students, and HR work on a single platform. The system automates student onboarding, attendance management, study materials, coding assessments, mock interviews, company drives, eligibility checking, notifications, reports, and analytics.

This reduces manual work, improves collaboration, provides real-time visibility into student performance, and helps institutes make faster and more informed placement decisions."

Challenge 1: JWT Authentication & Role-Based Security (Best Answer)

Answer:

"One of the biggest challenges was implementing secure authentication and authorization. Since the application has four different roles—Admin, Trainer, Student, and HR—I had to ensure that each role could only access its own APIs.

I implemented JWT authentication with Spring Security and created role-based access control. I also handled token validation, password encryption using BCrypt, and protected endpoints using Spring Security filters. This ensured that users could only access resources they were authorized to use."

Challenge 2: Bulk Student Import

Answer:

"Another challenge was bulk student registration. Instead of manually creating hundreds of student accounts, I implemented Excel import functionality.

While importing, I had to validate duplicate emails, generate unique student IDs, create secure passwords, assign students to batches, and send login credentials by email. I also added transaction-like validation so that invalid records could be identified without affecting valid ones."

Challenge 3: File Upload

Answer:

"I implemented file upload for study materials, resumes, and certificates. The challenge was supporting multiple file types while validating file size and format. I integrated Cloudinary for file storage and stored only the file metadata and URL in MongoDB."

Challenge 4: Judge0 Integration

Answer:

"Integrating Judge0 for coding assessments was challenging because the code execution is asynchronous. After submitting code, I had to poll for the execution result, process the response, calculate the score, and save the results in the database."

Challenge 5: Real-Time Notifications

Answer:

"I wanted students to receive notifications immediately when a trainer uploaded study material or scheduled a mock interview. I used Spring WebSocket to implement real-time notifications, while also storing notifications in the database so users could view them later if they were offline."

Challenge 6: Database Design

Answer:

"Designing the MongoDB schema was challenging because the application contains many related modules such as students, batches, company drives, interviews, and assessments. I carefully decided where to embed data and where to use document references to keep queries efficient and avoid unnecessary duplication."

"If you had more time, what would you improve?"

A good answer is:

"I would add AI-based placement readiness prediction, integrate video meeting APIs for mock interviews, improve analytics dashboards, introduce Redis caching for better performance, and deploy the application using Docker and Kubernetes for scalability."

2. Describe yourself in three words.

Answer:

"I would describe myself in three words:

- **Curious** – I enjoy learning new technologies and continuously improving my skills.
- **Consistent** – I believe regular practice and discipline are the keys to long-term success.
- **Responsible** – I take ownership of my work and always try to complete my responsibilities on time."

What makes you unique?

Answer:

"I believe what makes me unique is my combination of a strong learning mindset and practical project experience.

Instead of limiting myself to academic assignments, I focused on building real-world applications like IBNextStep, where I worked with Java, Spring Boot, React, MongoDB, JWT Authentication, WebSocket, and external API integrations.

Whenever I face a challenge, I don't look for shortcuts. I prefer understanding the root cause and finding the correct solution. This approach has helped me improve both my technical and problem-solving skills."

What does failure mean to you?

"I don't see failure as the opposite of success. I see it as an opportunity to learn and improve.

Whenever I face a setback, I first understand what went wrong, identify the root cause, and work on improving myself so I don't repeat the same mistake.

For example, when I first started learning Spring Security and JWT Authentication, I found the concepts challenging. Instead of giving up, I practiced consistently, studied the documentation, and eventually implemented them successfully in my project.

I believe every failure teaches us something valuable and helps us become better professionals."

Tell me about a conflict you had with a teammate.

Use the **STAR method (Situation, Task, Action, Result)**.

Answer

Situation:

"During my Java Full Stack training, our team was developing the **IBNextStep** project. While integrating the frontend and backend, one teammate wanted to change the API response format without informing the backend team. As a result, the frontend couldn't consume some APIs correctly, and we started facing integration issues."

Task:

"My responsibility was to identify the issue and ensure that both frontend and backend worked together without delaying the project."

Action:

"Instead of blaming anyone, I discussed the issue calmly with my teammate. We reviewed the API contract together, understood each other's requirements, and agreed to finalize a common response structure before making further changes. We also started communicating any API changes with the entire team before implementation."

Result:

"The integration issues were resolved quickly, and we completed the project on time. More importantly, I learned that clear communication and teamwork are just as important as technical skills. Addressing conflicts professionally leads to better collaboration and better results."

Tell me about a time you helped someone.

Answer (STAR Method)

Situation:

"During my final year of college, one of my classmates was absent for several lectures because of health issues. As a result, he was finding it difficult to understand the project requirements and complete his assigned tasks."

Task:

"I wanted to help him catch up so that he could contribute to the project and our team could complete it on time."

Action:

"I shared my notes, explained the project requirements, and helped him understand the concepts we had covered in class. We divided the remaining work based on our strengths, and whenever he had doubts, I guided him until he was comfortable with the tasks."

Result:

"He was able to complete his part of the project successfully, and our team submitted the project on time. This experience taught me that teamwork is about supporting each other and ensuring everyone contributes to the team's success."

Tell me about a time you failed to achieve a goal.

Answer (STAR Method)

Situation:

"During my second year of engineering, I participated in a coding competition organized by our college. My goal was to qualify for the final round."

Task:

"I prepared for the competition by practicing programming problems, but I underestimated the difficulty level of the questions."

Action:

"During the competition, I couldn't solve enough problems within the given time, so I wasn't selected for the final round. Instead of getting discouraged, I analyzed the questions I couldn't solve, identified my weak areas in data structures and algorithms, and started practicing regularly on coding platforms."

Result:

"Although I didn't achieve my goal in that competition, the experience motivated me to improve my problem-solving skills. It also helped me become more confident while working on projects like **IBNextStep**, where logical thinking and coding skills were very important."

1. What if you are assigned a project outside your comfort zone?

Answer:

"I would see it as an opportunity to learn. First, I would understand the project requirements, identify the skills I need, and start learning them through documentation, online resources, and guidance from my seniors or teammates. I believe every new project helps me grow, so I would give my best to deliver quality work."

What if your code causes a production issue?

Answer:

"If my code caused a production issue, I would immediately inform my team instead of hiding the mistake. I would work to identify the root cause, fix the issue as quickly as possible, test the solution thoroughly, and ensure the system is stable. After that, I would analyze what went wrong and take steps to prevent the same mistake in the future. I believe mistakes are opportunities to improve."

What if you receive two tasks with the same deadline?

Answer:

"I would first understand the priority and business impact of both tasks. If the priorities are not clear, I would discuss them with my manager. Then I would plan my time effectively, complete the higher-priority task first, and keep my manager informed about my progress. Good communication and proper planning are important in such situations."